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8520

THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

MEMORANDUM OF TELEPHONE CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: Telephone Call from Chancellor Helmut Kohl of
the Federal Republic of Germany (U)

PARTICIPANTS: The President
Helmut Kohl, Chancellor
Notetaker: Robert Hutchings

DATE, TIME October 23, 1989, 9:02 - 9:26 a.m. EDT
AND PLACE: The Oval Office

Chancellor Kohl initiated the call. (U)

The President: How are you? (U)

Chancellor Kohl: Fine. I am glad to hear your voice. I saw pictures of your visit to San Francisco and hope you will be able to give as much support as possible for that tragedy. (U)

The President: It is terrible, but the authorities there are doing well. We will help at this end in any way we can. (U)

Chancellor Kohl: I wanted to tell you briefly how I see events in Hungary, Poland, and the GDR. In Hungary, things are going the best. The people are incredibly courageous, and very determined. The present government is taking an enormous risk: the changes have their origin with the reform movement in the Communist Party, but it is not at all certain that the reformers will be able to get credit in the course of the election. It is quite possible that the Party will come in only second, and there might be a coalition. We have supported the Hungarians quite vigorously. In December I will go over for two days to give further support, also optically. (U)

The President: Where will you go? (U)

Chancellor Kohl: I will go to Budapest and perhaps also to a second city, but that is not certain. The economic situation is relatively good there. They can make it, though the next two years will be decisive. On November 9 I will go to Poland for four days. Our negotiations have been essentially concluded. I will do all I can to support the new government, especially in the economic area. With the EC, I intend to give assistance in human resources. This seems to be the problem, if I may put it bluntly: there is a lot of good will and many good ideas, but the Poles do

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Declassify: OADR

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PER E.O. 12958,

~~AS AMENDED~~

~~2000-0429-F~~

1999-0393-F

30 5/17/99

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-2-

not know how to put them into practice. They have to introduce currency reforms, a new banking system, and other steps to open up a new market-oriented economy. I will be doing what I can, and I will also take into account and work on what you have suggested, so that Western activities can be homogeneous. My feeling is that our Western friends and partners should be doing more. There is a difference between words and deeds. I also want to enter into a new phase with the Poles, 50 years after the outbreak of war. (Ø)

In the GDR, changes are quite dramatic. None of us can give a prognosis. It is not clear whether the new man will have the determination and the strength to carry out reform. Gorbachev told me that he had encouraged reform during his visit, but I am not sure how courageous he [new Party and state leader Egon Krenz] is. There is an enormous unrest among the population. Things will become incalculable if there are no reforms. My interest is not to see so many flee the GDR, because the consequences there would be catastrophic. Our estimates are that by Christmas we will have reached a total of 150,000 refugees, with an average age of under 30. (Ø)

My last point concerns the climate among the media in New York, the coast, London, the Hague, Rome, and Paris that, crudely speaking, holds that the Germans are now committed to Ostpolitik and discussions about reunification and that they are less interested in the EC and the West. This is absolute nonsense! I will again and again explain and declare my position. At the beginning of January, I will go to Paris to deliver a speech at a major conference. I will say publicly -- also to the left wing in the FRG -- that without a strong NATO, without the necessary development of the EC, none of these developments in the Warsaw Pact would have occurred. I am firmly convinced of that, and that will be my message. It would also be good for you, as soon as you can, to deliver a public message that progress in disarmament and changes in the east are possible only if we stand together. (Ø)

The President: I couldn't agree more. I have seen some of those stories, but I know your position and think I know the heartbeat of Germany. The strength of NATO has made possible these changes in Eastern Europe. We are seeing a spate of stories about German reunification resulting in a neutralist Germany and a threat to Western security. We do not believe that. We are trying to react very cautiously and carefully to change in the GDR. We have great respect for the way the FRG under your leadership has been handling this situation. You have done a great job. (Ø)

I understand that Horst [Teltschik, the Chancellor's security advisor] is coming soon. We are very anxious to talk with him on this subject and also about Poland and Hungary. We are getting criticism in the Congress from liberal Democrats that we ought to be doing more to foster change, but I am not going to go

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so fast as to be reckless. On Poland, the Congress is pushing us to put forward more money, but we are moving forward. I asked our Congress to approve a \$200 million grant, which would be our contribution to the \$1 billion stabilization fund the Polish government has requested. I consider it vitally important that we help Poland as it implements its economic reform program in the context of an IMF agreement. I am also sending a high level team from the public and private sectors to consult with the Poles and help them as they decide how to implement these reforms. (Ø)

Chancellor Kohl: I consider that a very important step, especially to have people from the public and private sectors. Let me ask you to have one of your collaborators call Horst Teltschik to talk this over. We have a similar approach, which we discussed with Mr. Delors. We want the EC to do the same. After my trip to Poland, I will send Horst to discuss these matters. (Ø)

The President: Is Horst here now? (Ø)

Chancellor Kohl: He was in New York a couple of days ago. The next time I will have him come down. (Ø)

The President: I thought he was coming to Washington. (Ø)

Chancellor Kohl: No. He is back now. (Ø)

The President: I will ask General Scowcroft to call him. (Ø)

Chancellor Kohl: Any time. (Ø)

The President: We ought to get together for an informal session, perhaps a few hours at Camp David. (Ø)

Chancellor Kohl: I will think it over and find out when I can make it. It would have to fit into one day. (Ø)

The President: We can do that. It is important to talk things over about Eastern Europe. I will see Thatcher around the time of our Thanksgiving. It is important to signal the importance I attach to U.S. relations with the FRG, especially when we see some of these mischievous stories around. (Ø)

Chancellor Kohl: I understand and think it is a very good idea. (Ø)

The President: Let's stay in touch. General Scowcroft will call Horst and tell you more about our approach toward Poland and our support for the stabilization fund. Let me also say that I appreciate this call very much. (Ø)

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Chancellor Kohl: Thank you. I will call again before I go to Poland, around the 6th or 7th of November. (Ø)

-- End of Conversation --

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Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

(George Bush Library)

Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
11. Memorandum	To: Robert Gates From: Philip Zelikow Re: Arranging Compatibility (1 pp.)	10/26/89	(b)(1)	C

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: October 1989 [1]

Date Closed: 5/12/2011	OA/ID Number: 30501-002
FOIA/SYS Case #: 2011-0002-F	Appeal Case #:
Re-review Case #:	Appeal Disposition:
P-2/P-5 Review Case #:	Disposition Date:
AR Case #:	MR Case #:
AR Disposition:	MR Disposition:
AR Disposition Date:	MR Disposition Date:

RESTRICTION CODES

Presidential Records Act - [44 U.S.C. 2204(a)]

P-1 National Security Classified Information [(a)(1) of the PRA]
P-2 Relating to the appointment to Federal office [(a)(2) of the PRA]
P-3 Release would violate a Federal statute [(a)(3) of the PRA]
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C. Closed in accordance with restrictions contained in donor's deed of gift.

PRM. Removed as a personal record misfile.

Freedom of Information Act - [5 U.S.C. 552(b)]

(b)(1) National security classified information [(b)(1) of the FOIA]
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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL

UNCLASSIFIED WITH
CONFIDENTIAL ATTACHMENT

WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

8600

10/26/89
1320

October 26, 1989

ACTION

MEMORANDUM FOR BRENT SCOWCROFT

THROUGH: DAVID C. MILLER, JR. *DMJ* / ROBERT D. BLACKWILL *RB*

FROM: NANCY BEARG DYKE *NT*

SUBJECT: Mrs. Thatcher's Public Comments on U.S. Policy on
Involuntary Repatriation

Brent --
As Henry Catto points
out, the most striking
thing about Mrs. Thatcher's
comment is her obvious
loss of control. A
worrying sign.
RB Blackwill

In a recent television interview and a subsequent British press report yesterday, Mrs. Thatcher publicly commented on our opposition to involuntary repatriation of Vietnamese boat people.

Attached is an information memorandum for the President that covers the comments and responds to them.

Concurrences by: Karl Jackson, Philip Zelikow *PZ*

RECOMMENDATION

That you sign the memorandum at Tab I to the President.

Attachments

Tab I Memorandum to the President

Tab A Cable re Mrs. Thatcher's Comments

UNCLASSIFIED UPON
REMOVAL OF CLASSIFIED
ATTACHMENTS
MB 5/12/11

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CONFIDENTIAL ATTACHMENT

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THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

8600

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DECLASSIFIED
PER E.O. 13526

2014-0174-MR

MM 6/21/2016

INFORMATION

MEMORANDUM FOR THE PRESIDENT

FROM: BRENT SCOWCROFT

SUBJECT: Mrs. Thatcher's Public Comments on U.S. Policy on
Involuntary Repatriation

The morning summary reports that Mrs. Thatcher has publicly noted that the U.S. deports Mexicans and Haitians and "That's the sort of double standards we are up against." The British press also reports her as saying countries who object very strongly to repatriating illegal immigrants should say they will take so many themselves.

Deporting Mexicans and Haitians is different from forcibly deporting Vietnamese because the nature of the countries and governments differ. We have said we oppose involuntary repatriation to a country like Vietnam, whose repressive regime distinguishes it from other countries. Our official position is that we oppose involuntary repatriation until there are dramatic changes in the political, social, and economic life of Vietnam. Comparing Vietnam with Mexico and Haiti is apples and oranges. We do not have a double standard.

We are taking as many refugees from Hong Kong as we can under our laws, plus we plan to parole some of those who have relatives here but do not qualify as bona fide refugees. The total we are committed to take from the ASEAN countries and Hong Kong is 22,000 "long stayers" and 50% of new arrivals who qualify as refugees. This is by far the most generous plan by any country and by far exceeds the record or plan of the UK to take boat people. The UK recently pledged to take 2,000 boat people. Historically we have taken hundreds of thousands more refugees from Indochina than has any other country.

I know we don't want a public quarrel with Mrs. Thatcher and the UK, and we have all tried to and will continue to try to avoid it. However, I did want to give you some information that addresses her public charges about our behavior on this issue. In any case, we don't expect the British to reverse their course on involuntary repatriation.

Attachment

Tab A Cable re Mrs. Thatcher's Comments

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Declassify on: OADR

cc: Vice President
Chief of Staff

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<DIST>PRT: SIT
SIT: BENKO DYKE SIT SUM VAX BLACKWILL ZELIKOW

<PREC> IMMEDIATE<CLAS> ~~CONFIDENTIAL~~<OSRI> RUFHLD<DTG> 251929Z OCT 89
<ORIG>FM AMEMBASSY LONDON
<TO>TO RUEHC/SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 4425
INFO RUEHHK/AMCONSUL HONG KONG PRIORITY 4069
RUEHKL/AMEMBASSY KUALA LUMPUR PRIORITY 2720
RUEHGP/AMEMBASSY SINGAPORE 1475
RUEHML/AMEMBASSY MANILA 9578
RUEHBK/AMEMBASSY BANGKOK 4285
RUEHJA/AMEMBASSY JAKARTA 3195
RUFHFR/AMEMBASSY PARIS 4913
RUEHKO/AMEMBASSY TOKYO 7560
RUEHGV/USMISSION GENEVA 3109
RUEHBY/AMEMBASSY CANBERRA 5597
RUEHWL/AMEMBASSY WELLINGTON 2611

DECLASSIFIED
PER E.O. 13526

2014-0174-MR
mm 6/21/2016

<SUBJ>SUBJECT: THATCHER GOES PUBLIC ON U.S. CRITICISM OF UK
POLICY ON VIETNAMESE BOAT PEOPLE IN HONG KONG

<TEXT>

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~ LONDON 21585

EXDIS

E.O. 12356: DECL: OADR

TAGS: PREF, PREL, CB, UK, MY, HK

SUBJECT: THATCHER GOES PUBLIC ON U.S. CRITICISM OF UK
POLICY ON VIETNAMESE BOAT PEOPLE IN HONG KONG

1. ~~CONFIDENTIAL~~ - ENTIRE TEXT.

2. IN AN OCTOBER 24 TELEVISION INTERVIEW FROM THE
COMMONWEALTH HEADS OF GOVERNMENT CONFERENCE IN KUALA
LUMPUR, PRIME MINISTER THATCHER NOTED THAT THE U.S.
REGULARLY DEPORTS MEXICANS AND HAITIANS WHO ENTER THE
U.S. ILLEGALLY, YET OPPOSES HONG KONG'S DEPORTING
VIETNAMESE BOAT PEOPLE FOUND NOT TO BE REFUGEES.
APPEARING GENUINELY UPSET, SHE SAID: "THAT'S THE SORT
OF DOUBLE STANDARDS WE ARE UP AGAINST." THIS EXCERPT
FROM THE INTERVIEW WAS REPEATED IN THE BRITISH PRESS
OCTOBER 25, WHICH ALSO REPORTED HER SAYING, "THOSE
COUNTRIES WHO OBJECT VERY STRONGLY WHEN IT COMES TO
REPATRIATING ILLEGAL IMMIGRANTS SHOULD SAY 'RIGHT, WE
WILL TAKE SO MANY OURSELVES,' BUT THEY ARE NOT DOING
THAT."

3. UK NEWS MEDIA ALSO REPORTED THAT THE MALAYSIAN
GOVERNMENT ANNOUNCED IT HAD MADE AN AGREEMENT WITH THE
UK THAT THE TWO GOVERNMENTS WOULD ACT TOGETHER, AT THE
SAME TIME AND IN IDENTICAL FASHION, IF THE TWO COUNTRIES
BEGAN INVOLUNTARY REPATRIATIONS OF VIETNAMESE BOAT
PEOPLE. NEWS REPORTS HERE ALSO NOTED CANADIAN PRIME
MINISTER MULRONEY'S EXPRESS HOPE THAT "IT DOESN'T COME
TO THAT (I.E., COMPULSORY REPATRIATION) AND HIS COMMENT
THAT SUCH A SCHEME WOULD "NOT FIND MUCH FAVOR IN CANADA."

4. COMMENT: WE HAVE NOT SEEN A TEXT OF THE ENTIRE
THATCHER INTERVIEW BUT PRESUME THAT IT ALSO COVERED HER
ISOLATED STAND (AND CONFERENCE TACTICS) ON THE ISSUE OF
SANCTIONS AGAINST SOUTH AFRICA, ACRIMONY OVER WHICH
REPORTEDLY CONTINUED TO THE VERY END OF THE CONFERENCE.
IT IS ANYTHING BUT THATCHER'S STYLE PUBLICLY TO CRITICIZE
THE U.S. HER DOING SO IN THIS FASHION IS REMARKABLY OUT
OF CHARACTER. WE SEE TWO POSSIBLE FACTORS BEHIND IT.
FIRST, AND MOST OBVIOUS, SHE FEELS BUILDING PRESSURE TO
"DO SOMETHING" ABOUT THE VIETNAMESE BOAT PEOPLE IN HONG
KONG AND IS GENUINELY FRUSTRATED BY WHAT SHE SEES AS
WASHINGTON'S RIGID, UNSYMPATHETIC STANCE. SECONDLY, BY
ALL ACCOUNTS, THIS HAS BEEN A FAIRLY HORRIBLE WEEK FOR
HER IN KL. SHE HAS APPEARED TO FEEL ALMOST A SENSE OF

BETRAYAL IN RESPONSE TO THE KIND AND DEGREE OF CRITICISM
THAT HER STAND ON SOUTH AFRICA SANCTIONS HAS ELICITED,
ESPECIALLY FROM HAWKE AND MULRONEY. ANGRY AND "SLIGHTLY
RATTLED," IS HOW SHE HAS AT TIMES COME ACROSS IN THE
MEDIA HERE. TIME SHOULD TELL WHETHER HER PUBLIC
REFERENCE TO THE U.S. WAS THOUGHT THROUGH OR WHETHER
CIRCUMSTANCES SIMPLY GOT THE BEST OF HER. IN EITHER
CASE, NOW WE KNOW HOW SHE FEELS.
CATTO

<SECT>SECTION: 01 OF 01<SSN> 1585<STOR> 891025185838 MSG000246653918
<TOR>891025191014

Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

(George Bush Library)

Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
13a. Memorandum	To: Brent Scowcroft From: Philip Zelikow Re: Open Skies (3 pp.)	10/25/89	(b)(1)	S

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: October 1989 [1]

Date Closed: 5/12/2011	OA/ID Number: 30501-002
FOIA/SYS Case #: 2011-0002-F	Appeal Case #:
Re-review Case #:	Appeal Disposition:
P-2/P-5 Review Case #:	Disposition Date:
AR Case #:	MR Case #:
AR Disposition:	MR Disposition:
AR Disposition Date:	MR Disposition Date:

RESTRICTION CODES

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Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

(George Bush Library)

Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
13b. Memorandum	To: Distribution List From: Philip Hughes Re: Open Skies Initiative (4 pp.)	n.d.	(b)(1)	C

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: October 1989 [1]

Date Closed: 5/12/2011	OA/ID Number: 30501-002
FOIA/SYS Case #: 2011-0002-F	Appeal Case #:
Re-review Case #:	Appeal Disposition:
P-2/P-5 Review Case #:	Disposition Date:
AR Case #:	MR Case #:
AR Disposition:	MR Disposition:
AR Disposition Date:	MR Disposition Date:

RESTRICTION CODES

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Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

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Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
13c. Memorandum	To: Philip Zelikow Re: Open Skies (9 pp.)	9/27/89	(b)(1)	S

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: October 1989 [1]

Date Closed: 5/12/2011	OA/ID Number: 30501-002
FOIA/SYS Case #: 2011-0002-F	Appeal Case #:
Re-review Case #:	Appeal Disposition:
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AR Case #:	MR Case #:
AR Disposition:	MR Disposition:
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Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
14. Memorandum	To: Brent [Scowcroft] From: Arnie [Kanter] Re: Open Skies (1 pp.)	10/26/89	(b)(1)	S

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: October 1989 [1]

Date Closed: 5/12/2011	OA/ID Number: 30501-002
FOIA/SYS Case #: 2011-0002-F	Appeal Case #:
Re-review Case #:	Appeal Disposition:
P-2/P-5 Review Case #:	Disposition Date:
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Originally Processed With FOIA(s):
2011-0002-F

FOIA Number:
2011-0002-F

FOIA MARKER

**This is not a textual record. This is used as an
administrative marker by the George Bush Presidential
Library Staff.**

Record Group/Collection: George H.W. Bush Presidential Records
Collection/Office of Origin: National Security Council
Series: European and Eurasian Directorate
Subseries: Central Chronological Files

OA/ID Number: 30501
Folder ID Number: 30501-002

Folder Title:
October 1989 [1]

Stack:

Row:

Section:

Shelf:

Position:

V

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